Getting Paid as a Vertical FDE

Front Matter, Chapter 9/12 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/how-to-get-paid

EN: The business series capstone: how everything this book taught turns into money, across a 9-station roadmap (4 reading stations ending in a decision, 4 building stations ending in an asset, then selling).
Roman Urdu: Business series ka capstone: book jo sikhati hai woh paison mein kaise badalti hai, 9-station roadmap par (4 reading stations decision tak, 4 building stations asset tak, phir selling).

1. Two Problems, One Gap

- Developers can't find work (agents write routine code); companies can't get ROI (~95% of custom pilots show no measurable return -- not weak models, nobody fits them into real data/rules/approvals). This is the **deployment gap**.
- **3 routes:** Freelance (projects become retainers), Job (deploy proven ability for salary), Startup (own a governed vertical asset). Most readers start on Row 1.

2. The Market's Answer: FDE, Two Gates

- FDE postings rose 800%+ in 9 months; AWS+Microsoft committed $3.5B. 2 gates the market closes: Lock-in (vendor FDEs build on their own platform) and the Hiring door (senior door: 5+ years, US/EU address).
- **Our answer: Vendor-neutral Vertical FDE** -- vendor-neutral solves lock-in, vertical solves the empty-hands problem (you land on a profession with a real, connectable SoR).

3. Nine Stations

- 1) Understand the Roles, 2) Understand the Ecosystem, 3) FDE AF Model, 4) Ownership Argument, 5) Choose a Vertical (8 tests), 6) Design the Vertical SoR (3-bin sort), 7) Build on the SoR Framework, 8) Connect the System of Context, 9) Go to Work (selling).
- **5-question pre-Station-5 test:** named senior practitioner? public-law-governed vertical? can fund 6-9 months? English-documented jurisdiction? can take cross-border payment?

4. Three Doors + Pay Table

- **3 doors** (used in order, not exclusive): Job, Freelance/fractional, Startup.
- **Pay:** Job ~$190K/yr median ($170-200K+ band); Freelance $2K-$15K+/project, $150-250/hr; Retainer $4K-$10K/month; Startup -- no band, you set the price.
- **4 pricing instruments:** Contract of success, Retainer (prices the Workers, not hours), Products. Caution: outcome pricing is only safe when the checker/eval set is real.

5. Eight Failure Modes

- Polishing a resume instead of building, launching with an unsigned expert, choosing the biggest market, shipping a slice as a demo, calling staff-aug an 'engagement', widening the vertical, skipping question 1, building the connecting layer first.

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
Deployment gap	The gap between AI capability and companies actually fitting it into real work.	AI capability aur companies ke real kaam mein fit karne ke beech ka gap.
Vendor-neutral Vertical FDE	An FDE who avoids platform lock-in and lands on a real profession.	FDE jo platform lock-in avoid karta aur real profession par land karta hai.
9-Station roadmap	Roles -> Ecosystem -> FDE AF Model -> Ownership -> Vertical -> SoR Design -> Build -> Context -> Sell.	Roles -> Ecosystem -> FDE AF Model -> Ownership -> Vertical -> SoR Design -> Build -> Context -> Sell.
3 Doors	Job, Freelance/fractional, Startup -- used in sequence, not mutually exclusive.	Job, Freelance/fractional, Startup -- order mein use hote, exclusive nahi.
Service ladder vs Vertical ladder	Service ladder earns now (no vertical needed); vertical ladder compounds later.	Service ladder abhi kamati (vertical zaroori nahi); vertical ladder baad mein compound hoti.

Viva Prep -- Representative Q&A;

Question	Answer
What's the 'deployment gap'?	Not that AI is weak, but that nobody fits it into a company's real data, rules, and approvals -- ~95% of custom pilots show no measurable return as a result.
What are the 2 gates the market closes against a regular FDE path?	Vendor lock-in (hurts the client) and the senior hiring door (hurts you -- 5+ years, US/EU address).
How does 'Vendor-neutral Vertical FDE' solve both gates at once?	Vendor-neutral removes lock-in; vertical removes the empty-hands problem by landing on a real, SoR-connectable profession.
What's the 5-question test before starting Station 5 (Choose a Vertical)?	Can you name a senior practitioner? Is it public-law-governed? Can you fund 6-9 months? Is the jurisdiction English-documented? Can you take cross-border payment?
Why is outcome pricing only safe under one condition?	Only when the checker/eval set behind it is real -- otherwise you're pricing a claim you can't actually verify.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: How to Sell (the missing selling-motion half). Full 28-Q quiz on the live book page.

Source: docs/how-to-get-paid/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.